Newsletter March 2023

Dear Members, Supporters, Patrons and Friends

We hope you are all well.

It has been six months since the last newsletter from London Kalibari was issued. Since then one of our founding members, Mrs Krishna Ghosh, has stepped down as a trustee, we staged our annual Kali Puja at Harrow Arts Centre in October 2022 and we have been overseeing the repair and renovation of LKB's headquarters at 18 and 20 Byron Road, Harrow.

UPDATE ON DAMAGE CAUSED TO 18 AND 20 BYRON ROAD, HARROW

As previously reported, London Kalibari's permanent home of 18 Byron Road, Wealdstone, Harrow, Middlesex HA3 7ST was damaged extensively by water leaking in from the flat and the terraced pathway located directly above our ground floor premises.

After Wealdstone Labour Hall Ltd, who were renting 20 Byron Road from LKB after selling the building to us in December 2021, vacated the property last summer, we discovered there was damage to that part of the building too due to water leaking from above.

It took months of discussions and assessments by the insurance company and various builders before the owners of the first-floor flat accepted that the leak originated from their property – and hence the leak continued to damage our ground floor premises for over 10 months.

Even after the insurance company shared their findings with us, LKB's trustees could not proceed with the necessary repairs as we were instructed by the insurance company that the source of the leak within the first floor flat had to be repaired before we could proceed with remedial work in our ground floor premises. Negotiations between LKB trustees and the owners of the flat lasted several months before finally water stopped leaking into our ground floor property in December 2022.

The insurance company's findings also highlighted that rain falling/water pooling on the terraced pathway leading to the two first-floor flats was also leaking into our premises due to its poor condition – hence an agreement needed to be reached between LKB trustees and the owners of the two flats to repair this pathway.

REPAIR AND RENOVATION OF 18 AND 20 BYRON ROAD

Since the beginning of December 2022, we have had a team of builders, plumbers and electricians -- headed by John Tiganescu -- carrying out repairs and renovation work at 18 and 20 Byron Road.

The entire ground floor was gutted/stripped back before repairs were carried out to the damaged ceiling and walls of the main puja and adjoining rooms. The cost of these repairs were covered by our insurance company.

Thanks to the generosity of our patrons, we have simultaneously been able to go ahead with the upgrade work that was necessary.

John's team of building experts are in the process of upgrading the outdated plumbing and electrical wiring systems within the building as well as renovating the three bathrooms/cloakrooms and kitchen within the premises. New ceiling lights, radiators, three external doors, windows, flooring etc are also being installed before the entire building – both internally and externally, is painted.

The courtyard attached to the property will also be renovated while the flat roof covering one of the rooms will be replaced.

The terraced pathway entrance to the two first floor flats, which is directly above our main hall, was also repaired last month before a new waterproof layer was laid by roof specialists who deal with such areas.

We attach a few photographs to illustrate the work in progress.


New entrance door


Entrance corridor


Main Hall


Main bathroom


Kitchen


Terraced roof

LONDON KALIBARI
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Registered address: 13 Kenton Gardens, Harrow, HA3 8DE Tel# 020- 8907-5946; E-Mail: kalibarilondon@gmail.com



RE-OPENING OF LONDON KALIBARI

Once the renovation work has been completed, we look forward to throwing open our doors again to our loyal supporters as we will be staging pujas within our premises, resuming the weekly luncheon club and holding other activities for our community.

FOUNDING MEMBER, MRS KRISHNA GHOSH, STEPPED DOWN AS TRUSTEE

We would like to offer our heartfelt thanks to Mrs Krishna Ghosh for her decades of service to London Kalibari. Mrs Ghosh stepped down as a trustee ahead of last September's AGM. In 1981, she was instrumental in setting up what we now recognise as LKB. An initiative that was initially championed by seven founding members has now grown into having hundreds of supporters with a permanent base at 18 Byron Road thanks to the dedication and fortitude shown by Mrs Ghosh and her ability to draw in other like-minded devotees and members of London's Bengali community.

PURCHASE OF TALLER PROTIMA FROM INDIA

We received delivery of our new fibreglass Protima from India in September and this will be housed in 18 Byron Road once the renovation work has been completed.

KALI PUJA HELD AT HARROW ARTS CENTRE ON 24 OCTOBER 2022

It was lovely to see so many familiar faces at our annual Kali puja held at Harrow Arts Centre on 24 October 2022. We had close to 400 devotees attending.

Puja was officiated by our regular priest Mr Robin Roy. Those in attendance praised the stage setting that was decorated by Ruby Bhattacharjee and Suhana Basu Roy.

The trustees would also like to thank Sangita Dasgupta, Debjani Sengupta, Tunu Paul, Kajol Roy, Shantanu D Gupta, Lina Dutta, Saswati Basu, Pijush Bhattacharjee, Aruna Sen, Sutanu Roy, Sikha Palit, Kuntala Palit, Bulbul Roy, Pompi Roy and Tanuj Ghosh and family for all their assistance on the day as without their help it would have been impossible to stage the puja successfully. Please forgive us if we have forgotten to mention anyone by name as many supporters offered assistance on the day.

Our regular caterer Dipak Sharma produced another delicious spread for all those present. Our trustees Rama Choudhury, Jayati Das and Debabrata Dey worked tirelessly before, during and after the puja to ensure the event was enjoyed by all those in attendance.

FOOD TOKENS TO BE INTRODUCED AT FUTURE PUJAS HELD IN HIRED PREMISES

We have decided to adopt the suggestion made by our patrons Saswati Basu and Kuntala Palit to issue tokens for food at all our main pujas in future. These tokens will be available for a fixed price per head at the donation station at any pujas we stage in hired premises.



HONOURING LKB FOUNDERS AND TRUSTEE BOARD MEMBERS

As mentioned in our previous newsletter, we are also planning to revamp the LKB website and include sections honouring:

1. The **founders** of London Kalibari
2. All those who held **elected positions** on the board of trustees
3. Non-trustees who have made **notable contributions** to Kalibari

Hence we would greatly appreciate if people could submit contributions to LKB founder and long-standing trustee Mrs Krishna Ghosh. To keep the process streamlined, we would like only **two-paragraph contributions on each person** – ie one paragraph should be on their background and one paragraph on their contribution to LKB.

Contributions can also be emailed to: **kalibarilondon@gmail.com**

UPDATING LKB MAILING LIST AND MEETING GDPR REQUIREMENTS

Your privacy is important to us and we would like to communicate with you about London Kalibari and its activities. **To do so we need your consent. If you object to any of the following, then please let us know at kalibarilondon@gmail.com and we will remove your details from our database.**

From 25 May 2018 the new General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) gives an individual more control over how their personal information is used. A brief explanation is given below on what data about you we use and your rights.

1. London Kalibari keeps your individual data such as your name, postal address and email address only for the purpose of informing you about forthcoming events of London Kalibari. We do not share your data with any other organisations or individuals.

2. You can at any time withdraw your consent, view the information kept about you and ask to delete part or all of the information on you.

3. You can lodge a complaint about misuse of information by speaking to one of the trustees.

We look forward to seeing you all soon and thank you for your continuing support.

Best wishes

London Kalibari Trustees: Dr Satya Chatterjee, Mrs Jayati Das, Mr Debabrata Dey, Mrs Rama Choudhury, Miss Pritha Sarkar